

PRACTICE LABORATORIES

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #138

For an improviser, knowing WHAT to practice is important. These things are the "experiments" that we are going to run as we practice. We need to experiment to see what works and what doesn't. Which ideas we'll keep and which we won't. That said, knowing HOW to practice is often much more important than knowing WHAT to practice. HOW do we run a successful experiment? Well, you need a good laboratory. Really, you need a number of different labs, each to be used for different experiments.

Here are just a few experiments to run, and some great laboratories to use for them.

Two Measure ii - V's	Minority, Recordame, Cherokee
One Measure ii - V's	Moment's Notice, Joy Spring, Ask Me Now
Circle Of Fourths	Sweet Georgia Brown, Just In Time, Rhythm Changes
I - vi - ii - V	Rhythm Changes, St. Thomas, Time After Time
Half Diminished Chords	Inner Urge, Windows, What Is This Thing Called Love
Minor ii - V's	Nature Boy, Softly As In A Morning Sunrise, Segment
Coltrane Changes	Giant Steps, 26-2, Satellite
Chromatic Chords	Well You Needn't, Night And Day, A Night In Tunisia

Minority (by Gigi Gryce)

The image displays four staves of musical notation for the 'Minority' exercise by Gigi Gryce. Each staff contains four measures, each with a single chord and a slash indicating a whole note. The chords are as follows:

Staff	Measure 1	Measure 2	Measure 3	Measure 4
1	Fm ⁶	Fm ⁶	Gm ⁷	C ⁷
2	Fm ⁶	Fm ⁶	Cm ⁷	F ⁷
3	Bbm ⁷	Eb ⁷	Abm ⁷	Db ⁷
4	F#m ⁷	B ⁷	Gm ⁷	C ⁷ ALT.